

'Batch Mode' window, add the selected files by clicking on the 'Add All' button on the right. Select the format that you would like the output to be in, click Start. And voila! Your task is done!

Manipulating images

Making changes in images, such as increasing or decreasing the brightness, saturation, contrast, colour, or even adding captions, is a breeze when done with batch conversion software.

To manipulate images in **Batch It!** click on the 'Settings' tab in the main window. In the 'Image

ground colour' by clicking on the 'Font' and 'Background' buttons. Select the way you want the text to be aligned from the Alignment field. Click on the 'Control Centre' tab and click the 'Process All' button to start the processing.

To manipulate images in **Advanced Batch Converter**, click on the 'Batch Mode' button. Select the files you wish to process and click 'Add All'. Select the 'Use Advanced Options' box and click 'Options'. Click on the 'Colour Effects' tab and make your selection for Negative or Greyscale.

Adjust the Brightness and Contrast properties as per your choice. You can also change the colour format by selecting the 'Change Colour depth' box and choosing between the

different colour formats (256, 16, 2 colours). You can also change the RGB count and swap colours (RGB to BRG, etc) by selecting the 'Swap Colours' box. You can add customised text to the images by clicking on the 'Crop/Flip/Mirror/Rotate/Text' tab. Select the 'Add Text' box and type in the text in the field below. Once you've selected the text, background colour and alignment, click 'OK'. Click 'Start' and you're done.

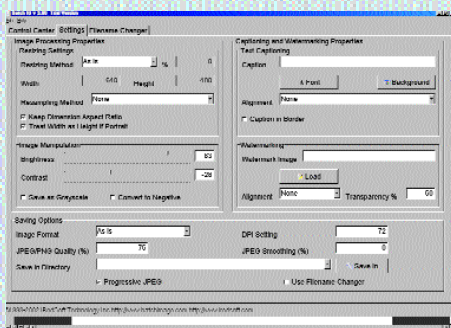


Image manipulation settings in Batch It!

Manipulation' field drag the 'Brightness and Contrast' sliders to increase or decrease the two properties. You can also select the 'Save as Greyscale' and 'Convert to Negative' check boxes if you want the images to be saved in black and white or as a negative. If you wish to add a text caption to the images, type in the desired text in the 'Text Captioning' field. You can also select the font, text colour and the back-

MISCELLANEOUS

Here are some varied tips that you designers might find useful



Screen capture

HyperSnap-DX 4.5 is quite a handy tool when it comes to taking screenshots as it allows you to capture and edit a full monitor screen, capture an image of a working window, or a selected area on the screen. Here's a closer look at this software. **Window capture mode:** To capture a screenshot of an open window on your monitor, keep the HyperSnap-DX main window as the active window. Click on 'Window or Control' in the Capture menu. A blinking frame appears around the window and you can move it around to envelope the entire window. Click the left mouse button or hit [Enter] and the captured image will be pasted onto the software's clipboard for you to edit. **Multi-region capture:** You can use this feature to cap-

ture screenshots of cascading menus. Open a multi-level menu (such as the one you get when you right-click on an icon) and click on 'Multi-Region Capture' under the 'Capture' menu or press [Ctrl] + [Shift] + [M]. A blinking box appears and you can move it around and click on each menu to make multiple selections. Once you've selected all the menus, press [Enter] and the screenshot is ready.

Colour tools

Any digital artist knows the heartache involved in getting that right shade of colour. But with these tools you can hit the bull's eye as they give you accurate colour code values.

To start with one of the easiest of colour tools, **3C** lets you pick any colour off your screen! Simply click on



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